Sitagliptin

Helps lower your blood sugar

WHAT DOES IT DO?

- Helps your body release insulin when blood sugar is high.
- Reduces sugar made by your liver.
- Helps control blood sugar in type 2 diabetes.



HOW SHOULD I TAKE IT?

- Take once daily, exactly as prescribed.
- Take with or without food.
- Swallow with water; do not crush or chew.
- Take at about the same time each day.
- Missed dose: take when remembered unless nearly time for the next dose. Never double the dose.



COMMON SIDE EFFECTS

- Headache
- Runny or blocked nose, sore throat
- Diarrhoea or nausea
- Joint pain (report severe or persistent pain)

Note: Low blood sugar is uncommon with sitagliptin alone but more likely with insulin or sulfonylurea medicines.



SYMPTOMS OF LOW BLOOD SUGAR (HYPOGLYCAEMIA)

- Shaking or sweating
- Sudden hunger
- Dizziness or weakness
- Fast heartbeat
- Confusion or difficulty concentrating



15–15 RULE FOR LOW BLOOD SUGAR

1. **If awake and able to swallow, take 15 g fast-acting sugar:** 3–4 glucose tablets (check label), ½ cup (120 mL) fruit juice/regular sugary soft drink, or 1 tablespoon sugar or honey.
2. **Wait 15 minutes** and check blood sugar if possible.
3. **If still below** 70 mg/dL, repeat 15 g and recheck after 15 minutes.

Once above 70 mg/dL and feeling better, eat a snack/meal if the next meal is not soon.

Safety: If unconscious, having a seizure, or unable to swallow, do not give food or drink by mouth; call emergency services and use glucagon if available.

SEEK MEDICAL ATTENTION IMMEDIATELY IF YOU DEVELOP

- Severe, persistent stomach pain that may spread to the back, with or without vomiting (possible pancreatitis).
- Face/lip/tongue/throat swelling or difficutly breathing (severe allergy).
- Severe blistering/peeling skin or mouth sores.
- Severe or persistent joint pain.
- Markedly reduced urination or new swelling of legs/feet.



IMPORTANT

- Tell your doctor if you have kidney problems or a history of pancreatitis.
- Sitagliptin dose may need adjustment for kidney function.
- Do not stop or change the medicine without asking your doctor or pharmacist.